5.2.1 Using the single-document API

Elasticsearch exposes a RESTful API to fetch a document given the document ID, similar to the indexing API we discussed in the previous section. The API definition for getting a single document is

```
GET <index_name>/_doc/<id>
```

`GET` is the HTTP method that indicates we are fetching a resource. The URL indicates the resource's endpoint—in this case, the `index_name` followed by `_doc` and the document ID.

As you may have noticed, the difference between indexing the document and fetching is just the HTTP verb: modifying `PUT/POST` to `GET`. There are no changes to the URL, following RESTful services best practices.

Let's retrieve the `movie` document with an ID of `1` that we indexed earlier. Executing a `GET movies/_doc/1` command on the Kibana console fetches the previously indexed document. The JSON response is shown in figure 5.6.

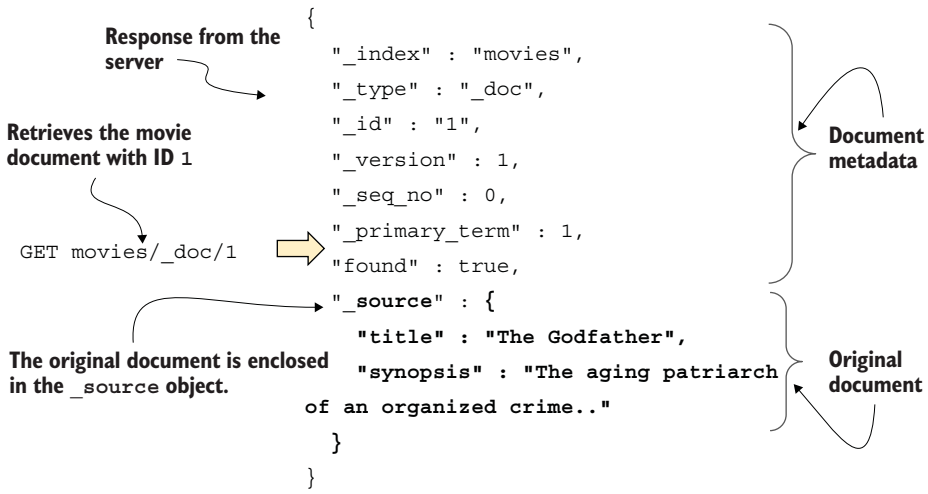


Figure 5.6 Retrieving a document using the `GET` API call

The response has two parts: the metadata and the original document. The metadata consists of `_id`, `_type`, `_version`, and so on. The original document is enclosed under the `_source` attribute. That's it! It is as simple as that to fetch a document if we know its ID.

The document may not exist in the store. If the document is not found, we get a response with the attribute `found` set to `false`. For example, trying to find a document with ID `999` (which doesn't exist in our system) returns the following response: